

THE THREE JUDGE PANELS

Panel 1: TECHNICAL

Background: Software engineers, architects, blockchain developers

What they will evaluate (30% weight):

- Code quality and repository structure
- Testing and reliability (unit tests, integration tests, edge case coverage)
- System architecture and scalability
- Smart contracts and x402 implementation
- Security practices and auditing
- Deployment and infrastructure

How to prepare for the Technical Panel:

- Have a working GitHub repository with clean code
- Show test coverage, even 50% is better than zero
- Create a system architecture diagram (even a simple one showing frontend → backend → blockchain)
- Have a clear README with setup instructions
- Be ready to explain: "How would you handle 10X users?"
- If you found any security issues, be honest about them and explain how you're addressing them
- Be prepared to do a live code walkthrough (5-10 min) of your most critical component

Panel 2: BUSINESS

Background: VCs, product managers, business strategists

What they will evaluate (40% weight) ← HIGHEST WEIGHT:

- Problem definition — Is this a real, validated problem?
- Total addressable market (TAM) — How big is the opportunity?
- Why blockchain? — Why is this solution blockchain-based, not just a regular app?
- Customer value proposition — What's the core benefit to users?
- Revenue model — How will you make money?
- Go-to-market strategy — How will you reach customers?

How to prepare for the Business Panel:

- Have a clear 1-sentence problem statement: "X users face problem Y, costing them Z"
- Be specific about your target customer. NOT "everyone." Examples: "DeFi traders in Southeast Asia," "Healthcare providers in Nigeria"
- Have talked to at least 5-10 potential customers. Be ready to share what they said.
- Have a TAM estimate with sources (market reports, competitor analysis). Even a rough estimate is fine.
- Be ready to defend: "Why blockchain and not just a traditional database + API?"

- Quantify your value: "30% cost reduction" or "3x faster" — NOT just "better"
- Have a revenue model. Doesn't need to be perfect, but must be realistic.
- Know your first 100 users strategy: "30 from X community, 20 from Y partnership, 50 from Z event"

Panel 3: SCALABILITY & EXECUTION

Background: Infrastructure architects, operations leaders, experienced founders

What they will evaluate (30% weight):

- Go-to-market strategy — How will you acquire customers?
- First 100 users plan — Specific, actionable strategy
- Architecture scalability — Can this handle 10X growth?
- Data and indexer strategy — How will you fetch blockchain data at scale?
- Infrastructure and cost planning
- Team capability and experience
- Roadmap and timeline
- Regulatory and compliance awareness
- Third-party dependencies and risk mitigation

How to prepare for the Scalability Panel:

- Have a specific GTM plan. NOT "go viral" or "organic growth." Be concrete.
- Know your first 100 users. Can you name specific communities, partnerships, or channels?
- Have a 6-month roadmap with clear milestones
- Understand your infrastructure needs. What's your monthly cloud cost? How does it scale?
- Be honest about team experience. If you're new to blockchain, say it. Then explain how you'll learn.
- Know which external services you depend on (indexers, RPCs, oracles) and what you'd do if they fail
- Be aware of regulatory risks. If there are KYC/AML implications, acknowledge them.
- Be ready to explain how you'll handle 10X users on your backend and blockchain

CRITICAL REMINDERS

Don't say "We haven't validated this yet." Judges want evidence, not promises.

Don't oversell your TAM. Be conservative. "First 0.1% of DeFi users in Asia" is better than "we'll capture 1% of global finance."

Be honest about what you don't know. "We're new to blockchain" is OK if you explain how you'll learn.

If judges ask a hard question, don't bullshit. "That's a great question, we haven't figured that out yet" is more credible than making something up.

Show your code and your work. Judges want to see you've actually built something, not just pitched an idea.